The stranglers

Some snakes – such as boas, pythons, and anacondas – capture and kill their prey by wrapping themselves around the animal until it can no longer breathe. These snakes are known as constrictors.

Burmese pythons can grow up to 20 ft (6 m) long.

Friend or foe?

Some Burmese pythons live close by humans. Often, they attack farm animals – but their feeding habits can also help to control the number of rats, and other vermin, in villages and cities.



Tropical living

Most species of boa live in the warm areas of Central and South America. This Cook's tree boa is a large, tree-dwelling snake found only in the Caribbean islands.